Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ 9 7 ♥ A K 9 6 ♦ A Q 9 7 4 ♣ A 5	
♠ 10 6 2 ♥ Q 2 ♦ 10 5 3 2 ♣ 7 6 4 3		♠ 8 5 4 ♥ J 4 3 ♦ J 8 6 ♣ 10 9 8 2
	♠ A K Q J 3 ♥ 10 8 7 5 ♦ K ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠4

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that South has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q J 5 2 ♥ 7 ♦ 9 6 4 3 ♣ Q 8 6 4	
♠ A 6 3 ♥ A K 9 8 6 5 ♦ K ♣ A 3 2		♠ K 7 ♥ Q J 3 ♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5 ♣ K
	♠ 10 9 8 4 ♥ 10 4 2 ♦ 2 ♣ J 10 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♦	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♣[2]	Pass	5NT[3]	Pass
6♦	Pass	7NT	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards
3. asks for kings

7NT by East
Lead: ♣J

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ — ♥ A 10 9 6 ♦ K Q J 7 4 ♣ J 10 8 3	
♠ K Q 7 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ A 6 5 3 2 ♣ 9 4		♠ A J 9 5 4 2 ♥ 5 2 ♦ 9 8 ♣ 7 5 2
	♠ 10 8 6 ♥ K Q J 8 3 ♦ 10 ♣ A K Q 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ 2
♥ 9 5 3 2
♦ A Q J 10 4
♣ Q 9 8

♠ K Q J 9 6 5
♥ A K
♦ 8 7 5
♣ A 5

♠ A 10 8 4 3
♥ Q 10 8 4
♦ —
♣ K J 10 2

♠ 7
♥ J 7 6
♦ K 9 6 3 2
♣ 7 6 4 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
1♠	Pass	4♦	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♦	Pass
7♠			
All Pass			

7♠ by West
Lead: ♥3

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 8 7 ♥ A 10 6 ♦ Q 9 7 4 ♣ J 10 8	
♠ J 9 6 2 ♥ J 9 5 3 ♦ 5 2 ♣ 4 3 2	N W E S	♠ 10 4 3 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ J ♣ 9 7 6 5
	♠ A Q 5 ♥ 4 ♦ A K 10 8 6 3 ♣ A K Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	5♠	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

7NT by North
Lead: ♥K

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥A. You answer 5♣ and partner bids 5♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7♦ but when you told him you had the ♦Q, ♥A and ♠K he was able to bid 7NT.

Board 6
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A K J 6 5 2
♥ 5
♦ A 8 7 4
♣ 7 5

♠ Q 8
♥ A J 9 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A K Q 6

♠ —
♥ K Q 10 8 6 3 2
♦ 5 3
♣ J 10 8 2

♠ 10 9 7 4 3
♥ 4
♦ 10 9 6 2
♣ 9 4 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦10

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.